

Quick reference: symptom, likely cause, first action, and escalation

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Authority: Simulated demo guidance. Primary source: *Dark Store Last-Mile Dispatch Playbook* (sample operations document, illustrative thresholds only), section 7.

Applies to: Fast triage during a peak and deciding when to escalate to regional operations. Each section below is one symptom.

High rider wait with pending orders above 2 per available rider

Symptom: Rider wait is high and there are more than about 2 pending orders per available rider.

Likely cause: Too few riders online or free.

First action: Dispatch the oldest waiting order first, call in a standby rider, and batch eligible orders under DD-BATCH-001.

Escalate to regional ops when: No standby rider is available and rider wait stays high for 15 minutes or more.

High pick-pack time with orders stuck in picking

Symptom: Pick-pack time is high and orders are sitting in the picking state.

Likely cause: Picker shortage, a stock-out, or a mis-slotted item.

First action: Reassign a picker and check the top-10 items for stock. Adding riders will not fix this.

Escalate to regional ops when: A high-volume item is out of stock.

High ride time with the rain flag on

Symptom: Ride time is high and it is raining.

Likely cause: Wet roads and slower, safer riding.

First action: Show customers a longer, honest ETA, shrink the serviceability radius, and apply the surge incentive within the store's cap. Never ask riders to ride faster.

Escalate to regional ops when: There is flooding, or an incentive above the store's cap is needed.

Rider near the shift or break limit

Symptom: A rider is close to the 9-hour shift maximum or has gone nearly 4 hours without a break.

Likely cause: Long continuous work.

First action: Stop dispatching to that rider and arrange a break or relief, following DD-RIDER-001.

Escalate to regional ops when: Relief cannot be arranged.

Frozen item in a waiting order

Symptom: A waiting order contains frozen or ice-cream items.

Likely cause: Cold-chain constraint.

First action: Deliver it single-drop only, never batched, and dispatch it promptly.

Escalate to regional ops when: Not applicable.

Many outer-zone (Z-C) orders waiting

Symptom: A large number of waiting orders are in the outer zone, Z-C.

Likely cause: Long rides consuming rider capacity.

First action: Pair Z-C orders only with orders in adjacent zones, and consider pausing the outer zone.

Escalate to regional ops when: The outer-zone backlog is sustained for 30 minutes or more.